

Knowledge Organiser (LAUNCH W3): Evaluating a digital archive source

Humanities Aut 1 · 2026–27 · Workbook outcome: Research a digital archive source; evaluate it.

Key Word	Definition
reference	The diagram above lays out the seven fields of the catalogue record: reference, title, description, date, held by, format and access. Each field answers a different question, and an evaluation earns its judgement by pointing to the field that answers the question the judgement depends on.
title	The diagram above lays out the seven fields of the catalogue record: reference, title, description, date, held by, format and access. Each field answers a different question, and an evaluation earns its judgement by pointing to the field that answers the question the judgement depends on.
description	The diagram above lays out the seven fields of the catalogue record: reference, title, description, date, held by, format and access. Each field answers a different question, and an evaluation earns its judgement by pointing to the field that answers the question the judgement depends on.
date	The diagram above lays out the seven fields of the catalogue record: reference, title, description, date, held by, format and access. Each field answers a different question, and an evaluation earns its judgement by pointing to the field that answers the question the judgement depends on.
held by	The diagram above lays out the seven fields of the catalogue record: reference, title, description, date, held by, format and access. Each field answers a different question, and an evaluation earns its judgement by pointing to the field that answers the question the judgement depends on.
format	The diagram above lays out the seven fields of the catalogue record: reference, title, description, date, held by, format and access. Each field answers a different question, and an evaluation earns its judgement by pointing to the field that answers the question the judgement depends on.
access	The diagram above lays out the seven fields of the catalogue record: reference, title, description, date, held by, format and access. Each field answers a different question, and an evaluation earns its judgement by pointing to the field that answers the question the judgement depends on.
Watch the method:	Watch the method: I read the model evaluation's first sentence, which says the list was "created by the archive in 1948". I check the description field, which says the list was compiled by the shipping line, and the held-by field, which names the archive as custodian rather than creator. The sentence has confused the record with the document, which is the first error family on the checklist, so I mark it and write the correction beside it, naming both fields. Read the claim, find the field, name the error family, correct.

Key Facts

- An archive holds original documents; a catalogue record describes one of them in fixed fields, and a digitised copy reproduces it, so three different things can share one title.
- A transcription is a typed copy made later by someone else, so an error in it is not an error in the original, and the catalogue usually says which you are reading.

Arrival Task

Retrieving what an archive record is

1) An archive holds original documents; a catalogue record describes one of them in fixed fields, and a digitised copy reproduces it, so three different things can share one title.

2) A transcription is a typed copy made later by someone else, so an error in it is not an error in the original, and the catalogue usually says which you are reading.

Why does an evaluation need a field to point to?

Consider two evaluations of the same record. Evaluation A: “The passenger list is a reliable source because it is in a national archive.” Evaluation B: “The passenger list is reliable for the names, ages and stated occupations of those who sailed, because the description field shows it was compiled by the shipping line at the time of the voyage for official purposes; it is less useful for why they came, because the format field shows it records only what the form asked.”

We Do 1: Spot the error in three sentences

Sentence 1: “The list is reliable because it was created by the national archive in 1948.”

Sentence 2: “Because the record was digitised in 2018, the information dates from 2018.”

Sentence 3: “The list is useful because it tells us why every passenger chose to come to Britain.”

We Do 2: Correct the model evaluation together

We correct one sentence on the board before anyone writes: each learner records a corrected version of the same sentence on a whiteboard with the field it now points to, and only when every board is raised do we compare and agree the correction.

Scaffolding – Stretch

Word Bank

reference, title, description, date, held by, format, access, Watch the method:, Space, Voice, Audience, Influence

Your route

Complete the standard route, then judge how far the digitised copy can stand in for the original and name one thing the record cannot tell.

Sentence frames

"Who ... what they do ... so that ..." | "... because ..."



Reference Zone — keep this beside your work

The model

Watch the method: I read the model evaluation's first sentence, which says the list was "created by the archive in 1948". I check the description field, which says the list was compiled by the shipping line, and the held-by field, which names the archive as custodian rather than creator. The sentence has confused the record with the document, which is the first error family on the checklist, so I mark it and write the correction beside it, naming both fields. Read the claim, find the field, name the error family, correct.

Repairing it together: rewrite the sentence as "The list is reliable for who sailed but not useful for why they came, because the format field shows the form asked for occupation and not for motive," which places the record correctly on both axes and names the field that fixes its position.

Check yourself

- Check yourself: does every evaluation claim say reliable for what or useful for what?
- Check yourself: can you point to a catalogue field for every claim you made?

From the lesson sheet

Evaluating a digital archive source

SoW: 'LAUNCH Weekly - Autumn'!C48 — "Research a digital archive source; evaluate it."

Learning objective: I can research a digital archive record from its catalogue fields, spot and correct errors in an evaluation, and evaluate the record for reliability and usefulness with reasons that point to the fields.

No live connection is required and no learner researches their own family. Every task is completed from the supplied offline catalogue extract and its printed fields.

The evaluation row

Claim → reliable for or useful for → the catalogue field it rests on.

The first row is completed for you from the correction we made together and is set in italics so that it is not mistaken for your own; complete as many of the rows below it as you can.



Independent Work – Stretch

The standard route plus a judgement on the digitised copy and what the record cannot tell.

Complete the standard route, then judge how far the digitised copy can stand in for the original and name one thing the record cannot tell.

Claim about the record	Reliable for, or useful for?	Catalogue field it rests on
<i>compiled by the shipping line at the time, not by the archive</i>	<i>reliable for who sailed</i>	<i>description; held by</i>

Choose a route

1. I chose my own route.
2. My evaluation is in my own words.
3. Any adult help is written on the record.

5 · Learner confirmation

I confirm this is my own work.

Learner name (print)	Signature
Date	

Exit Ticket – Stretch

1) Read one claim to a partner or an adult; the listener repeats the field they heard it rest on, in their own words.

2) If the listener heard a different field from the one you meant, change the wording so that the field is unmistakable; the change is your influence and belongs to you rather than to the listener.

3) SPACE stays available, VOICE is received, AUDIENCE names back exactly and INFLUENCE changes one real next action.

Lundy Loop — this lesson

SPACE stays available, VOICE is received, AUDIENCE names back exactly and INFLUENCE changes one real next action.

Space	,
Voice	
Audience	
Influence	

Evaluating a digital archive source — Feedback Sheet

Keep with your book / folder.

Pupil name:	Date:
WWW (What Went Well): 	
EBI (Even Better If): 	
Level worked at: Supported / Standard / Stretch	Evidence filed: Yes / Not yet
Authorship — what I chose or decided myself: 	
Support given — prepared / scribed / modelled / hand-over-hand: 	
Pupil response — my next step: 	